FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-24-21002

Issue Title : 737 MAX Missing Dual Ground Path for Standby Power Control Unit (SPCU) on P6 Panel to Airplane Ground

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2400-00	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
08/04/2021	05/23/2022	05/19/2022
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

The Milestones Section have been updated.

This FTD is the final revision since the Service Bulletin has been released and the parts are availble. The Service Related Problem (SRP) Project 737MAX-SRP-24-0236 is being closed out.

Description

During the bonding and grounding analysis conducted for NNC 21-9, it was determined that a loss of ground through the P6 Panel could result in a loss of function in the Standby Power Control Unit (SPCU).

The single ground strap design has been used successfully on the 737NG fleet from entry into service to present, and there has been no reported failures of this ground strap in service history of about 218 million flight hours. This ground strap is located in the flight deck compartment which is considered a dry area and therefore is not susceptible to corrosion. It is installed at the bottom of the P6 structure and is not subject to any mechanical bending or deflection.

There is the potential for multiple flight deck effects to occur. It is difficult to predict with certainty how a crew will cope with a combination of effects that has not been anticipated. This conservative assessment regarding bonding/grounding of the SPCU/ P6 led to the conclusion that the potential combination of flight deck effects and/or combination of lost functionality warrants a new SB.

Boeing also conducted an investigation in the factory and on the undelivered stored airplanes. The bonding and grounding

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conditions will be addressed and corrected prior to any upcoming delivery.

In-Service 737MAX aircraft line numbers affected by this issue are as follows:

There are total 409 affected aircraft from LN 5602 to LN 7424.

Of which there are 381 delivered aircraft to be included in the Service Bulletin.

There are 4 ATC/Flight Test Aircraft that have the EQC work complete (5728/1A003, 6744/1E001, 6798/1E002, 7285/1F001).

There are 17 Un-ticketed Aircraft added to the EQC - Action plan added on 7/8/2021.

There are 4 Ticketed Aircraft to be reworked by MR (7323/1C453, 7163/1D201, 7325/1C304, 7345/1C305).

There are 2 Ticketed Aircraft to be included in the SB (7155/1B568, 7248/1B569) - Schedule for rework by MR not achievable prior to delivery commitment (MR would be a Major change).

There is 1 Ticketed Aircraft TBD (7293/1B578) - on-going discussion with the customer.

Note the 737 MAX airplanes from LN 7425 and forward are covered by SB 737-24A1246 required prior to flight. These airplanes are modified to provide a redundant ground path for the P6 structure prior to flight and are therefore not covered by this FTD.

Background

Ground paths are required to maintain bus switching functionality within the SPCU. The grounds terminate in the two different ground blocks mounted on the SPCU Tray. The ground paths for the SPCU tray include a single ground strap between the P6 Panel and primary aircraft structure.

It was determined that another separate redundant ground path from the two ground blocks on the SPCU tray to airplane primary structure is required in order to prevent a single point of failure condition and meet the intended function of the SPCU design. Loss of the single ground strap to airplane primary structure from the P6 Panel may also result in the loss of additional systems affecting the combined impact.

Status

Boeing authorized Service Related Problem (SRP) 737MAX-SRP-24-0236 to investigate the lack of dual ground path issue for the

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Standby Power Control Unit (SPCU). Boeing has completed the review via Continued Operational Safety Process (COSP) and has determined that this issue is Safety related. Boeing is working to release a service bulletin (SB: 737-24A1248 RB) to correct the lack of dual ground path condition. FAA approved the compliance recommendation on 22-Sep-2021.

The Service Bulletin 737-24A1248 was released on 16-May-2022. Parts have been available since 22-Dec-2021.

Interim Action

Boeing has conducted Lead Airline Call meetings during the week of July 4th and MAX Out of Sequence Calls during the week of July 11th to continue sharing information on these upcoming changes with 737 MAX Operators and answer their questions.

Boeing presented the "737 MAX Missing Dual Grounding Path for Standby Power Control Unit (SPCU) on P6 Panel to Airplane Ground" on 27-Oct-2021 during the 737NG/MAX Fleet Team Meeting held in Long Beach, CA USA from 26-Oct-2021 to 28-Oct-2021.

Final Action

Boeing will release a MAX Alert Service Bulletin 737-24A1248 RB for the affected 737-8/-9 airplanes to provide part information and repair instructions to correct the lack of dual ground path condition. Boeing recommends Operators achieve compliance by accomplishing the instructions in the Alert Service Bulletin 737-24A1248 RB within three years from the release of the Service Bulletin.

The Service Bulletin has been released on 16-MAY-2022 and parts are available. Boeing recommends Operators to achieve compliance by accomplishing the instructions in the Alert Service Bulletin 737-24A1248 RB within three years from the release date 16-MAY-2022 of the Service Bulletin.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Acceptance by the Board: 23-APR-2021 (complete)

Safety Decision: 23-APR-2021 (complete)

Root Cause Established: 10-JUN-2021 (complete)

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Solution Selected: 10-JUN-2021 (complete)

Compliance Recommendation submitted to FAA: 16-JUN-2021 (complete)

Lead Airline Call (LAC): 07-JUL-2021 (complete)

Plan Approval: 15 JUL-2021 (complete)

FAA Approval of Compliance Recommendation: 22-SEP-2021 (complete)

Change Committed (PRR 3M9900-037RS is firmly committed): 14-SEP-2021 (complete)

Service Bulletin Available: 16-MAY-2022 (complete)

Parts Available: 22-DEC-2021 (complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-24A1246	R00	05/12/2021
Service Related Problem (SRP)	737MAX-SRP-24-0236	New	04/23/2021
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-24A1248	New	

Related Categories

- Fleet Team IdeaXchange : Topic of discussion on the Fleet Team IdeaXchange bulletin board
- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

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